

Strategic three-movers

By C.G.S.Narayanan

"Variation play is most fundamental chess problem effect of all and is most satisfying when it is logically necessary" wrote Robin Matthews, one of the finest composers of strategic three-movers of modern era. Self-block has been used in variation play extensively as a strategic form of black defence in problems of different kinds. In the problem below by the great Russian composer for study, the three main lines are sufficiently curious and interesting. After the **key 1.Qa3!** The quiet threat is 2.Qf3 followed by double threat 3.Nd7/Qf4

Lev Loshinski

I prize Kubbel Mem.Ty 1945-46



Mate in three moves

The defence 1...Nxf6 leads to 2.Qb4 Nxe4 3.Bd4 mate, a white interference. After 1...Bf5 the battery opens differently 2.Be3! Kxf6 followed by 3.e5 mate. Again white interference is caused by the self block on f5. There is a third of the same kind in the extended field of black king in the variation 1...g5 2.Bd6 Kxf6 3.Be5.

The White queen is used cleverly to guard d6 and e7 during the play including the line following the BK flight. 1...Kxf6 2.cxd8Q Rxd8 3.Be7. A brilliant combination of battery play and white interference.

Leonid Zagoruyko
2 Pl.USSR Championship 1953



Mate in three moves

In the second problem above two white line pieces guard e5. While threat closes one the black defence closes the other. **Key 1.Bf7!** Try 2.Nh5 threatens 3.Ng7 2.Re3/Be3 3.Qf4/Ng3 but refuted by 1...Bh6! The true threat is 2.Qf6+ Kg4 3.Bh5 After 1...Re3 2.Nh5 (3.Qf4) 2...R~ 3.Ng7/Ng3 accordingly and 2...Rxe5+ 3.Rxe5. If 1...Be3 2.Ne2 (2.Ng3) 2...B~ 3.Qf4/Nxd4 accordingly. The e3 Grimshaw is complete. If 1...Ne3 2.Nxh3 (2.Qf4) 2...N~ 3.Qe4 and 2...Ng4!?(self-block) 3.Qxh7.

Finally a quaternary black correction For solving.

Robin Matthews

I prize, Observer 1964



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Tries and white correction':

1.Nf7?(2.Qe5/Qxf4) Qc3! 1.Nc4? Bb8! (2.Qc4?) **Key 1.Nc6!** (2.Qe5/Qxf4) 1...Bb8/Qxf5 2.Rd4/Bd5

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